## Adding CSS Transitions

When we add the new CSS class to our elements in the previous example, the transform property changes the orientation of the element on the screen. However, we can change the element in other ways. Our new classes could specify a background color, change the margin, add a border, and so on. There are many, many properties of a DOM element that can change with the addition of new CSS classes. Generically, we can call these property changes *transitions*.

CSS provides what you can think of as a meta-property called transition. The transition property allows you to describe the behavior of the CSS element when one of its display properties changes. The default behavior is that the property changes instantly.

It doesn't take much syntax to use the transition property to make our arrows move; all we need to do is add one new CSS class to our CSS (again, Tailwind can do this for us, too, but we'll keep using plain CSS):

chapter_05/03/app/assets/stylesheets/application.tailwind.css

```
.slow-transition {
  transition: all 0.5s ease-in-out;
}
```

The new line here is transition: all 0.5s ease-in-out;, which specifies that we want properties to transition in a non-default way.

The syntax of the transition property has up to four elements:

- The first is either the name of the property being observed, or the special words all or none. The rotation angle, strictly speaking, doesn't have a property, so it can only be captured using all. But if you only wanted to transition on changes to background-color or margin, for example, you could limit the change by only including one property. There's a specific list of what changes can be transitions, but the short of it is that basically anything where you could potentially list all the steps between values is fair game.